Obstacle Planning

Level 6 · Strategic Goals and Planning

Name _____ Date _____

Research on goal-setting shows that people who plan for their obstacles in advance are far more likely to follow through than people who only picture success. In this exercise you will take the goal you set in SMART Goals and prepare for the three things most likely to get in the way.

The obstacle you have planned for is already half handled.

PART 1 Your Goal

Start with the goal you are committed to.

MY GOAL

My goal is to …

Why this goal matters to you

When the obstacles come, this is what you will come back to.

PART 2 Your Three Obstacles

Be honest. Include the obstacles inside you, such as doubt or procrastination, as well as the ones around you.

Obstacle 1

THE OBSTACLE

EARLY WARNING SIGN

IF THIS HAPPENS, I WILL...

Obstacle 2

THE OBSTACLE

EARLY WARNING SIGN

IF THIS HAPPENS, I WILL...

Obstacle 3

THE OBSTACLE

EARLY WARNING SIGN

IF THIS HAPPENS, I WILL...

PART 3 Your Back-Up Plan

Even with a plan, some days will not go well. Decide now what you will do on those days.

The minimum version of your goal

On a difficult day, what is the smallest action that still keeps you moving?

Who can support you?

A person, a group, or a resource you can turn to.

The obstacle you have planned for is already half handled.